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WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Novo Nordisk's big bet** to improve on the success of its weight-loss drug franchise hit a stumbling block, wiping out nearly $100 billion of the drugmaker's stock-market value. **A1**

◆ **VW said it had agreed** to a deal with its union to reduce its workforce by more than 35,000 and cut billions of dollars a year in costs while averting immediate factory closures in Germany. **B9**

◆ **The Dow, S&P 500** and Nasdaq rose 1.2%, 1.1% and 1%, respectively, but each ended the week down at least 1.8% after Wednesday's selloff. **B10**

◆ **A top financial regulator** sued JPMorgan Chase, Bank of America and Wells Fargo, alleging they allowed fraud to run rampant on the payments platform Zelle. **B9**

◆ **Netflix has secured** the U.S. rights to stream the next two women's soccer World Cups, a major step forward in its bet on live sports. **B9**

◆ **Starbucks baristas** launched protests at some union-represented locations in three cities after the union said talks with the chain hit an impasse. **B9**

◆ **Crypto news website** CoinDesk dismissed its top three editors, after the publication of a since-deleted story prompted backlash from a crypto titan. **B9**

World-Wide

◆ **The Republican-led House** approved revised legislation to avert a government shutdown and provide more than $100 billion in disaster and farm aid, sending the measure to the Senate just hours ahead of the midnight deadline. **A1**

◆ **A driver rammed** a car into a German Christmas market, leaving at least two people dead and more than 60 injured. **A7**

◆ **Trump has threatened** to impose tariffs on European imports unless the continent buys more American oil and gas. **A2**

◆ **Biden is considering** commuting the sentences of the 40 men on the federal government's death row. **A4**

◆ **Eight people** were convicted of helping the man who beheaded a French schoolteacher four years ago after he showed caricatures of Islam's Prophet Muhammad. **A7**

◆ **The war in Ukraine** has taken a toll on Russia's stockpiles of armored vehicles, forcing Moscow to deplete its Soviet-era stockpiles and change tactics. **A8**

◆ **Malaysia has tapped** a marine-robotics company to resume the search for missing Flight MH370, which disappeared in 2014 with 239 people on board. **A8**

◆ **Canadian leader** Justin Trudeau lost the support of the New Democratic Party, which has been propping up his minority government. **A6**

NOONAN
What is your attitude toward Trump 2.0? **A13**

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College Playoff Is Off to a Cold, Snowy Start

MICHAEL REAVES/GETTY IMAGES

SALTY: Indiana and Notre Dame kicked off the new 12-team college football playoff Friday night in snowy South Bend, Ind., where the Fighting Irish hosted the Hoosiers, the first of four games this weekend, including SMU vs. Penn State. **A14**

Novo Nordisk Shot Falls Short In Obesity War, Sinking Shares

By Peter Loftus And Dominic Chopping

Novo Nordisk's big bet to improve on the success of its weight-loss drug franchise hit a stumbling block Friday, wiping out nearly $100 billion of the drugmaker's stock-market value.

The Danish company—which had become Europe's biggest by market capitalization on booming sales of Ozempic and Wegovy—reported disappointing results of a closely watched clinical trial testing an experimental anti-obesity treatment that the company hoped would be its next big weight-loss product.

The two-drug combination, dubbed CagriSema, helped study volunteers lose a significant amount of weight, some 22.7% on average after more than a year's treatment. And the drug might still make it to market. But the magnitude of weight loss it induced in the study fell short of the company's and investors' expectations.

The steep dive in Novo's shares, which plunged nearly 21% in Europe, shows the pitfalls of the large and fast-growing weight-loss drug market that the Danish company helped create. Novo has prospered by spearheading the sale of drugs that can help people lose substantial amounts of weight, but the bar that it set with rival Eli Lilly is proving tough even for Novo to top.

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◆ **Heard on the Street: New tariff threat on oil..... B11**

House Approves Measure To Avoid Shutdown

Proposal extends federal funding and provides disaster aid, leaves out debt limit

WASHINGTON—The Republican-led House approved stopgap spending legislation to avert a government shutdown and provide more than $100 billion in disaster and farm aid, sending the measure to the Senate just hours ahead of the midnight deadline.

*By **Katy Stech Ferek**, **Siobhan Hughes** and **Lindsay Wise***

Lawmakers voted 366-34 on Friday evening to approve the proposal, well above the two-thirds threshold needed under special fast-track procedures. The Democratic-controlled Senate was on track to pass the legislation late Friday and send it to President Biden's desk for his signature.

The bill marked House Speaker Mike Johnson's third attempt to combine a three-month funding extension with emergency aid this past week, after wrestling with competing demands from President-elect Donald Trump, his billionaire efficiency czar Elon Musk, internal GOP critics and Democrats.

Johnson (R., La.) was forced to formulate the latest approach after a bipartisan plan released Tuesday was torpedoed by Musk and Trump, and a slimmed-down measure backed by the president-elect that included a debt-ceiling increase was defeated resound-

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James Bond Battles A New Foe: Amazon

The franchise is stuck in a tug-of-war between the family that controls 007 and the e-commerce giant

By Erich Schwartzel and Jessica Toonkel

James Bond has dodged more than 4,000 bullets. He has jumped from an airplane, skied off a cliff and escaped castration by laser beam.

Now, 007 is in a new kind of peril.

Nearly three years after Amazon acquired the right to release Bond movies through its $6.5 billion purchase of the Metro-Goldwyn-Mayer Studio, the relationship between the family that oversees the franchise and the e-commerce giant has all but collapsed. The decaying partnership has scuttled any near-term hope of a new Bond film—a black eye for Amazon's ambitions in Hollywood, since at the time of the MGM sale, the Bond franchise represented a significant share of the $6.5 billion the company paid for the studio.

When it comes to Bond's future, the power lies in the hands of Barbara Broccoli, who inherited the control from her father, Albert "Cubby" Broccoli, and who for 30 years has decided when a new Bond movie can go into production. She has told friends she doesn't trust algorithm-centric Amazon with a character she helped to mythologize through big-screen storytelling and gut instinct. This fall, she characterized the status of a new movie

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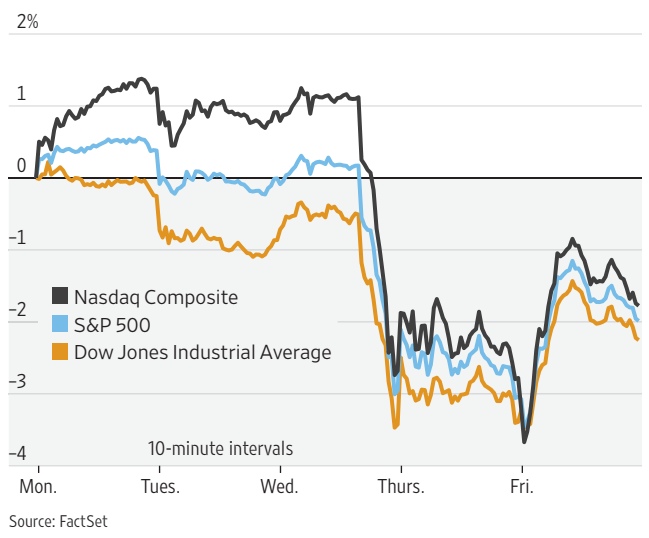
Stocks Rise but Fall for Week

Major U.S. stock indexes each rose more than 1% on Friday, clawing back some of Wednesday's steep drop. **B10**

Index performance this past week



Source: FactSet

As Drone Hysteria Grips State, World Wonders: Why New Jersey?

* * *

Sightings launch a thousand theories while 'Sky Watch' monitors flying objects

By Joshua Chaffin

MENDHAM, N.J.—By day, Bud Murphy is a divorce lawyer. On Wednesday evening, though, the 53-year-old father of three was working a different job: drone spotter for the town's newly formed Sky Watch Task Force.

Murphy was stationed in the local Borough Park by a gazebo strung with Christmas lights to comb the night sky for signs of the drones that have been unnerving Mendhamites for weeks.

Accompanying him for the group's inaugural stakeout was its founder, Mayor Christine Serrano Glassner, 62, and Chris Neff, 57, who typically looks for animals in his job as a conservationist at the New Jersey Audubon. Both were wearing custom-made Sky Watch hats emblazoned with a drone logo.

"I'm running out of answers for my kids," Murphy said of the flying objects he has been seeing, and sometimes chasing with his car.

"People are getting nervous," Neff said.

Drone hysteria is gripping

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EXCHANGE

CODE NAME: ORION
The next great leap in AI is behind schedule and crazy expensive. **B1**

Ghosts Make the Most In Hot Writing Market

By Jacqui Shine

Reality stars don't typically pride themselves on their literary prowess. Sandy Yawn of Bravo's seafaring series "Below Deck" is no exception. "I'm not a writer," the superyacht captain said. "I was kicked out of 11th grade, and I went into the maritime industry."

She does, however, consider herself a storyteller. So when "the fans started asking for a leadership book," Yawn said, she hired Samantha Marshall to help.

Marshall spent weeks interviewing Yawn about her life. She learned about the time Yawn's ship caught fire in the Red Sea and the motorcycle crash that led Yawn to a kidney-cancer diagnosis. And where details were foggy, she spoke to Yawn's family members and crew. "Sandy is the type of person who looks forward more than backward," said Marshall, a former Wall Street Journal reporter.

Their book, "Be the Calm or Be the Storm: Leadership Lessons from a Woman at the Helm," was published in 2023 by Hay House Business. Marshall is credited on the title page.

Ghostwriters have long been part of the world of pub-

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